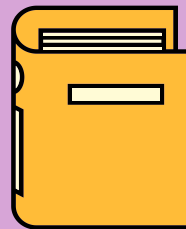


UX Research & Brand Identity Study

Ziyan Wang (Ryan)





Project Overview

UX Study

Objective:

Create and test a unique brand identity for *Ryan Big Brain*, a surreal indie game studio.

Method:

- Created a visual style guide
- Ran A/B user testing with 3 participants
- Used *UX for Beginners* and Norman's 3 Processing Levels
- Iterated based on real feedback

Goal :

Build a brand that feels smart, weird, and emotionally sticky — just like our games.

Brand Strategy (ZAG)

Signature quote:
"Games that feel like fever dreams written by
a philosopher with a meme addiction."

Core Identity:

- *Ryan Big Brain* designs surreal, story-driven puzzle games with emotional depth and weird humor.

Why We're Different:

- We blend *brainy gameplay* + *bold design* + *comedic chaos*
- The only indie studio that makes you laugh, cry, and overthink in the same 5 minutes

Want more? Full ZAG method (17 answers) available in the appendix.



"We tested various fonts and colors with participants to find the combo that felt smart, strange, and visually bold. Final picks reflected readability + personality."

Visual Identity: Style Guide

Company Style Guide

B

Company Name : Ryan Big Brain

Mission Statement:

Before: Ryan Big Brain creates emotionally rich, weirdly smart games that blend humor, heart, and head-scratching puzzles. We design for curious minds who crave story, style, and something different in every pixel.

After: We design bold, story-driven games that spark curiosity, stir emotions, and reward big brains and big hearts alike. At Ryan Big Brain, we believe games should surprise you, challenge you, and stay with you long after the credits roll.

Font Family

Ryan Big Brain

Brittany

Ryan Big Brain

Grand Hotel

Ryan Big Brain

School Bell

Color Palette





Study Participants

Shuwei

24 years old, gamer, CS major, Carnegie Mellon University

Feedback:

Liked the **console-style logo**

Said black & white felt "too boring" for a game studio

Preferred something **colorful and punchy**



Edward

20 year old ,Gamer & engineering major, University of Manchester

Feedback:

Console logo **grabbed his attention first**

Said the slogan "**doesn't need to change**" — already strong

Felt it aligned well with an indie game studio



Ophylia

22 year old, University of Southern California. Business

Feedback:

Sample A logo **color looks old school**, clean, **slogan is shit, can't really understand.**

Sample B logo too ugly,slogan not good not bad.



A/B Testing Results: Logo & Slogan

Option A:

Logo: 🎮 Retro handheld console
Seen as **clear, game-related, and direct**

"Looks like a real game studio logo"

slogan: Descriptive, emotional, and familiar
"Feels like it sums up the brand"



RYAN BIG BRAIN
PUZZLE. LAUGH. FEEL. REPEAT.

Option B:

logo: 🧠 Brain-shaped spade with "R"
Seen as **more artistic and abstract**
Less instantly recognizable as gam

slogan: Catchy, rhythmic, and clever
"Cool slogan — makes me curious"

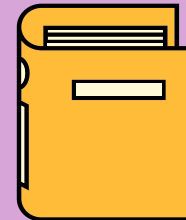
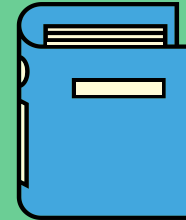


RYAN BIG BRAIN
PLAYWEIRD THINKBIG

People liked the **clarity of Logo A** and the **personality of Slogan B.**



WHICH ONE?



D

Final Design & Redesign

Final Logo:

Selected: Retro handheld console (Logo A)

Why: Instantly signals "games"

Clean silhouette, easy to recognize

Matches brand's quirky-smart identity

Redesign Touches:

Added bold gradient background

Increased font weight

Layered title text for dimension

"Our final picks combine visual clarity with a bold, surreal personality."

Final Slogan: "Play Weird. Think Big."

Why It Stuck:

Unique and memorable

Matches the emotional/brainy duality

Reflects the ZAG – creative, clever, and chaotic



E

Key Insights & Reflection

Clarity Wins First Impressions

Logos and fonts that were instantly recognizable performed better
Simplicity doesn't mean boring — it means understandable

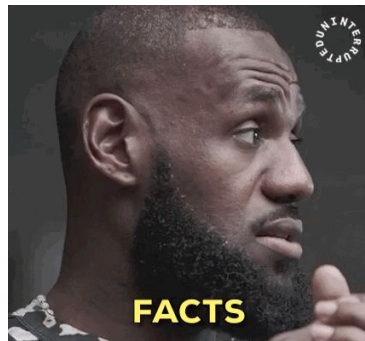
Weird is Welcome (When It's Grounded)

Participants liked abstract or clever elements
But only when tied to something familiar (like a game console shape or bold colors)

The Power of Tone

The right slogan can say more than a paragraph
Users connected more deeply with phrases that matched the *emotional + intellectual* vibe

FINAL THOUGHT :
DESIGN ISN'T JUST HOW IT LOOKS — IT'S HOW IT MAKES PEOPLE FEEL, THINK, AND REMEMBER.



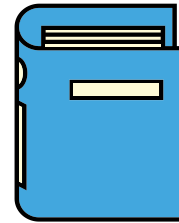
THANKS

Do you have any questions?

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Appendix + References

- [Research Script](#)
- [Zig Zag](#)
- [Interview Script](#)
 - Norman, D. (2013). *The Design of Everyday Things* (Revised Edition). Basic Books.
 - Krug, S. (2006). *Don't Make Me Think*.
 - UX for Beginners: A Crash Course in 100 Short Lessons by Joel Marsh